With this helper and the additional requirement of your project and task files, you have all you need to run this test file directly from the command line without using the rake task provided by Rails:

```
% rspec spec/models/project_spec.rb
.................

Finished in 0.06155 seconds (files took 0.4728 seconds to load)
17 examples, 0 failures
```

rspec spec/models/project_spec.rb is run all by itself and it works, bypassing the Rails environment. The RSpec command line reports how long the file load takes preceding the test, so I can confidently tell you that on my machine the Rails version takes about 3.25 seconds and the non-Rails version takes about 0.5. That's not a bad savings, especially considering that the load time for the Rails version is only going to increase over time.

One warning: if you separate rails and non-Rails tests, you need to run your non-Rails tests separately. Otherwise Rails will load anyway, and you'll lose the speed advantage and get some extra flakiness based on Rails being loaded at an arbitrary point in the suite. Also, SQLite seems to really, really not like combining regular Rails connections with this kind of ad hoc ActiveRecord connection. As a result, you may have trouble with this technique using SQLite, but changing the database to something more production-ready like PostgreSQL or MySQL should help.

active_record_test_helper in Minitest

The same Rails-bypassing test technique works in Minitest, but there are some minor differences based on the way the RSpec executable works versus the way Minitest works.

In Minitest, the active_record_test_helper looks like this:

environment/01/test/active_record_test_helper.rb

```
require "minitest/autorun"
require "mocha/mini_test"
require "active_record"
require "active_support/test_case"
require "minitest/reporters"
require_relative "../app/models/application_record.rb"

reporter_options = {color: true}
Minitest::Reporters.use!(
  [Minitest::Reporters::DefaultReporter.new(reporter_options)])

connection_info = YAML.load_file("config/database.yml")["test"]
ActiveRecord::Base.establish_connection(connection_info)
```